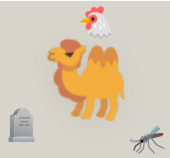
STUDY AID · MATTHEW 23 · EPISODE 45 (#48 OF 58 IN THE PLAYLIST)



The Weightier *Matters*

Strain out a gnat, swallow a camel

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 23 in the LSB | 42:33 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: Jesus' Most SAVAGE Moment (Matthew 23 Explained). Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads all of Matthew 23. Speaking to the crowds and His disciples, Jesus says the scribes and Pharisees sit in the chair of Moses: do what they tell you, but not what they do, for they do all their deeds to be noticed by men. He forbids titles that grant honor (Rabbi, father, instructor), then pronounces seven woes on the scribes and Pharisees, laments over Jerusalem, and says, 'your house is being left to you desolate.'
- Moses' seat stands for teaching authority, like a pulpit today. Jesus has no problem with what they teach but with how they live. The heavy burdens are a yoke they will not carry themselves, and 'to be noticed by men' repeats the warnings of the Sermon on the Mount (6:1, 5).
- Each woe turns on irony: careful tithes of mint, dill and cumin while neglecting justice, mercy and faithfulness; straining out a gnat (the smallest unclean swarming thing, Leviticus 11:41) while swallowing a camel (Leviticus 11:4); clean cups, unclean hearts; whitewashed tombs. Those who honor dead prophets are the sons of those who killed them.
- The woes echo the six woes of Isaiah 5:8-23 ('Woe to those who call evil good and good evil'), and the video follows an outline of them as a chiasm whose center is 23:23-24, the weightier provisions of the Law (Micah 6:8).
- The lesson: when people commit themselves to hypocritical righteousness, God's word becomes

> *"When people commit themselves to hypocritical righteousness, as Jesus defines it, God's word becomes distorted and his will becomes corrupted.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Why does Jesus save his harshest critiques? Not for unbelievers, not for Rome, not for pagans, but for the religious.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

distorted and His will becomes corrupted, and over time they become blind to spiritual truth. Humility is the cure.

Find the center

Read the seven woes as a chiasm: the parts mirror each other, and the center (23:23-24) carries the main point.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 45 of the Matthew study (playlist item 48).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 23 and turns to Matthew 5 and 6, Exodus 13, Deuteronomy 6 and 11, Numbers 15 and 19, Genesis 14, Leviticus 11, Jeremiah 7, 2 Chronicles 24, Psalm 118, Isaiah 5 and Micah 6. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 23
Read in full: the seven woes and the lament over Jerusalem.

Matthew 6:1-5
To be noticed by men.

Matthew 5:20
Righteousness that surpasses the scribes and Pharisees.

Exodus 13:9
A sign on your hand: the phylactery texts.

Deuteronomy 6:8
Phylacteries between your eyes.

Numbers 15:37-41
Tassels on the corners of garments.

Genesis 14:18-20
Abram gives Melchizedek a tenth.

Leviticus 11:4
The camel is unclean.

Leviticus 11:41
Every swarming thing is detestable.

Numbers 19:16
A bone or a grave makes one unclean seven days.

Jeremiah 7:25-26
I have sent you all My slaves the prophets.

2 Chronicles 24:20-22
Zechariah is stoned in the court of the house of Yahweh.

Psalm 118:22-26

Isaiah 5:8-23

The rejected stone; blessed is the one who comes.

Isaiah's six woes.

Micah 6:8
Do justice, love lovingkindness, walk humbly.

Key verses in the LSB

"You blind guides, who strain out a gnat but swallow a camel!"
Matthew 23:24 (LSB)

"But the greatest among you shall be your servant."
Matthew 23:11 (LSB)

"He has told you, O man, what is good; / And what does Yahweh require of you / But to do justice, to love lovingkindness, / And to walk humbly with your God?"
Micah 6:8 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The chair of Moses

Teaching authority, a performance, and the cure of humility.



MATTHEW 23:1-4

The chair of Moses

MATTHEW 23:2-3 (LSB)

AUTHORITY

"saying: "The scribes and the Pharisees have seated themselves in the chair of Moses; therefore all that they tell you, do and keep, but do not do according to their deeds; for they say things and do not do them."

FROM THE VIDEO The Jewish leaders have probably left after the questions of chapter 22, so Jesus speaks to the crowds and disciples. Moses' seat stands for teaching authority, the equivalent of the pulpit today.

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus' problem is not how they teach but how they live. The heavy burdens are a yoke, a rabbi's way of life, that they will not carry themselves (23:4).

BACKGROUND Stone 'seats of Moses' have been found in ancient synagogues, for example at Chorazin.

◆ Factbook: Scribe ◆ Factbook: Pharisees ◆ Factbook: Moses ◆ Factbook: Yoke (teaching as a yoke)



MATTHEW 23:5-7; 6:5

To be noticed by men

JESUS · MATTHEW 23:5

JESUS, EARLIER · MATTHEW 6:5

“But they do all their deeds to be noticed by men; for they broaden their phylacteries and lengthen the tassels of their garments.”

““And when you pray, you are not to be like the hypocrites; for they love to stand and pray in the synagogues and on the street corners so that they may be seen by men.”

FROM THE VIDEO The same antagonist as in the Sermon on the Mount: 'unless your righteousness surpasses that of the scribes and Pharisees' (5:20). Matthew 5:20

FROM THE VIDEO Phylacteries held Scripture from Exodus 13:9 and 16 and Deuteronomy 6:8 and 11:18; tassels honored Numbers 15:38-39. They made them large, to be seen. Exodus 13:9 Deuteronomy 6:8 Numbers 15:38-39

BACKGROUND Hypokritēs was the Greek word for a stage actor, one who plays a part.

◆ Factbook: Hypocrite ◆ Factbook: Tassel (tzitzit) ◆ Factbook: Sermon on the Mount



MATTHEW 23:8-12

One Teacher, one Father

MATTHEW 23:11-12 (LSB) HUMILITY

“But the greatest among you shall be your servant. And whoever exalts himself shall be humbled; and whoever humbles himself shall be exalted.”

FROM THE VIDEO The titles are not banned in themselves; Jesus corrects titles used to bestow privilege and honor. Verse 12 ends by setting humility against exaltation.

BACKGROUND Compare 20:26-27, where the great one among you is your servant. Matthew 20:26-27

◆ Factbook: Rabbi ◆ Factbook: Humility

> *“Why does Jesus save his harshest critiques? Not for unbelievers, not for Rome, not for pagans, but for the religious.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Seven woes

The video reads the woes as a chiasm; the center is the weightier provisions of the Law.

MATTHEW 23:13-32 (LSB): THE SEVEN WOES AS A CHIASM; THE VIDEO'S CENTER IS GOLD

A 23:13 But woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you shut off the kingdom of heaven from people

B 23:15 you travel around on sea and land to make one proselyte

C 23:16 Woe to you, blind guides

D 23:23 and have neglected the weightier provisions of the Law: justice and mercy and faithfulness

C' 23:25 For you clean the outside of the cup and of the dish

B' 23:27 For you are like whitewashed tombs

A' 23:29 For you build the tombs of the prophets

The video's outline: A, failure to recognize the Messiah (and A', the prophets); B, zeal that does more harm than good; C and C', misguided use of Scripture; D, the center, failure to discern the thrust of Scripture.



MATTHEW 23:13-15

Shutting the door

MATTHEW 23:13 (LSB)

WOES 1 AND 2

““But woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you shut off the kingdom of heaven from people; for you do not enter in yourselves, nor do you allow those who are entering to go in.”

FROM THE VIDEO Spreading the kingdom was the very job they were meant to do, and they refuse. Instead they travel to make one proselyte, a God-fearing Gentile, and put their heavy yoke on him (23:15).

BACKGROUND Verse 14 appears in brackets in the LSB because the earliest manuscripts lack it; it matches Mark 12:40. Mark 12:40

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven ◆ Factbook: Gentiles ◆ Factbook: Gehenna



MATTHEW 23:16-22

Blind guides and their oaths

MATTHEW 23:16-17 (LSB)

WOE 3

““Woe to you, blind guides, who say, ‘Whoever swears by the sanctuary, that is nothing; but whoever swears by the gold of the sanctuary is obligated.’ You fools and blind men! For which is more important, the gold or the sanctuary that sanctified the gold?”

FROM THE VIDEO They ranked oaths upside down: the lesser thing bound you, the greater did not. If you say you will do something, just do it, as Jesus taught in Matthew 5:33-37. Matthew 5:33-37

FROM THE VIDEO The video cites a commentator: oaths by the temple or altar were thought meaningless because no lien could be put on them.

◆ Factbook: Oath ◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)



MATTHEW 23:23-24; LEVITICUS 11

A gnat and a camel

JESUS · MATTHEW 23:23

MOSES · LEVITICUS 11:41

““Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you tithe the mint and dill and cumin, and have neglected the weightier provisions of the Law: justice and mercy and faithfulness; but these are the things you should have done without neglecting the others.”

“‘Now every swarming thing that swarms on the earth is detestable; it shall not be eaten.”

FROM THE VIDEO Mint, dill and cumin are tiny herbs; tithing them takes great precision. The gnat is the smallest unclean swarming thing, the camel the biggest unclean animal that chews the cud (Leviticus 11:4). **Leviticus 11:4**

FROM THE VIDEO Justice, mercy and faithfulness run all through the Tanakh: 'to do justice, to love lovingkindness, / And to walk humbly with your God' (Micah 6:8). **Micah 6:8**

BACKGROUND Tithing goes back to Abram, who 'gave him a tenth of all' (Genesis 14:20). **Genesis 14:20**

◆ Factbook: Camel ◆ Factbook: Unclean (ritual purity) ◆ Factbook: Mercy ◆ Factbook: Micah (the prophet)



MATTHEW 23:25-28; NUMBERS 19:16

Clean cups, whitewashed tombs

JESUS · MATTHEW 23:27

““Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you are like whitewashed tombs which on the outside appear beautiful, but inside they are full of dead men’s bones and all uncleanness.”

MOSES · NUMBERS 19:16

“Also, anyone who in the open field touches one who has been slain with a sword or who has died naturally, or a human bone or a grave, shall be unclean for seven days.”

FROM THE VIDEO Pilgrims on the way to a festival could brush against a tomb and become unclean, so tombs were whitewashed about a month before Passover. They looked clean, but the white was a warning: dead and unclean inside.

BACKGROUND The Mishnah: on the fifteenth of Adar 'they also mark the Jewish gravesites anew' (Mishnah Shekalim 1:1), and 'graves with lime which is dissolved and poured on' (Mishnah Maaser Sheni 5:1).

◆ Factbook: Unclean (ritual purity) ◆ Factbook: Lawlessness



MATTHEW 23:29-36

From Abel to Zechariah

JESUS · MATTHEW 23:35

“so that upon you may fall the guilt of all the righteous blood shed on earth, from the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of Zechariah, the son of Berechiah, whom you murdered between the sanctuary and the altar.”

THE CHRONICLER · 2 CHRONICLES 24:21

“So they conspired against him and at the command of the king they stoned him to death in the court of the house of Yahweh.”

FROM THE VIDEO They honor the dead prophets while doing what will lead to Jesus' death and His followers'. Abel to Zechariah runs from the first martyr to the last in the Old Testament, which ends with 2 Chronicles in the Hebrew order.

FROM THE VIDEO 'I am sending you prophets' echoes God in Jeremiah 7:25: 'I have sent you all My slaves the prophets.' Jesus does what Yahweh does. **Jeremiah 7:25-26**

◆ Factbook: Zechariah (son of Jehoiada) ◆ Factbook: The Prophets (books) ◆ Factbook: Persecution



Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees

James Tissot, Woe unto You, Scribes and Pharisees, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"That's what it means to strain out a gnat and swallow a camel.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Jerusalem, Jerusalem

The lament, Psalm 118, and Isaiah's woes.

MATTHEW 23:37-38

As a hen gathers her chicks

MATTHEW 23:37-38 (LSB)

LAMENT

""Jerusalem, Jerusalem, who kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to her! How often I wanted to gather your children together, the way a hen gathers her chicks under her wings, and you did not want it. Behold, your house is being left to you desolate!"

FROM THE VIDEO 'Jerusalem' is a metonymy, a name standing for something closely related, like 'the White House' for the president's staff. Jesus means the corrupt leaders.

FROM THE VIDEO He prophesies judgment on the leaders, the city and the temple.

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem ◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

MATTHEW 23:39; PSALM 118:22, 26

Until you say, 'Blessed'

JESUS · MATTHEW 23:39

"For I say to you, from now on you will not see Me until you say, 'Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord!'""

THE PSALMIST · PSALM 118:22

"The stone which the builders rejected / Has become the chief corner stone."

FROM THE VIDEO Psalm 118:26 comes a few verses after 118:22, the rejected stone Jesus used in chapter 21. Israel will not see Him again until they recognize Him as the one who comes in the name of the Lord. **Psalm 118:26**

◆ Factbook: Cornerstone ◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms

ISAIAH 5:20; MATTHEW 23:23

Woe to those who call evil good

ISAIAH 5

⚖ ISAIAH 5:20 (LSB)

"Woe to those who call evil good and good evil, / Who substitute darkness for light and light for darkness, / Who substitute bitter for sweet and sweet for bitter!"

FROM THE VIDEO The seven woes recall Isaiah's six (Isaiah 5:8-23), which follow the song of the vineyard, the same picture behind the parable in Matthew 21.

FROM THE VIDEO Feigning righteousness for self-glory sets humility aside, and without humility no one can do justice, love mercy and walk humbly with God.

◆ Factbook: Isaiah ◆ Factbook: Humility



He wept over the city

Enrique Simonet, Flevit super illam, 1892. Museo del Prado via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"Somewhere along the way, obedience became a performance of righteousness.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in Matthew 23

What the video says, then a short background note.

The scribes and Pharisees

VIDEO Sit in Moses' seat; teach rightly but live for applause.

The crowds and the disciples

VIDEO Jesus' audience once the leaders have left.

BACKGROUND Not every religious leader was corrupt; Nicodemus and Joseph of Arimathea are examples.

Matthew 23:2 | John 3:1 | ◆ Scribe | ◆ Pharisees | ◆ Nicodemus

BACKGROUND The warning is for everyone who has ears to hear.

Matthew 23:1 | ◆ Disciples

Abel

VIDEO The first righteous martyr.

BACKGROUND 'The voice of your brother's blood is crying out to Me' (Genesis 4:10).

Genesis 4:8-10 | ◆ Abel

Zechariah

VIDEO The last martyr in the Old Testament, in 2 Chronicles 24.

BACKGROUND The Chronicler names him son of Jehoiada the priest; Matthew has 'son of Berechiah.'

2 Chronicles 24:20-22 | Zechariah 1:1 | ◆ Zechariah (son of Jehoiada) | ◆ Zechariah (father of John the Baptist)

Abram and Melchizedek

VIDEO The first tithe, a tenth of everything.

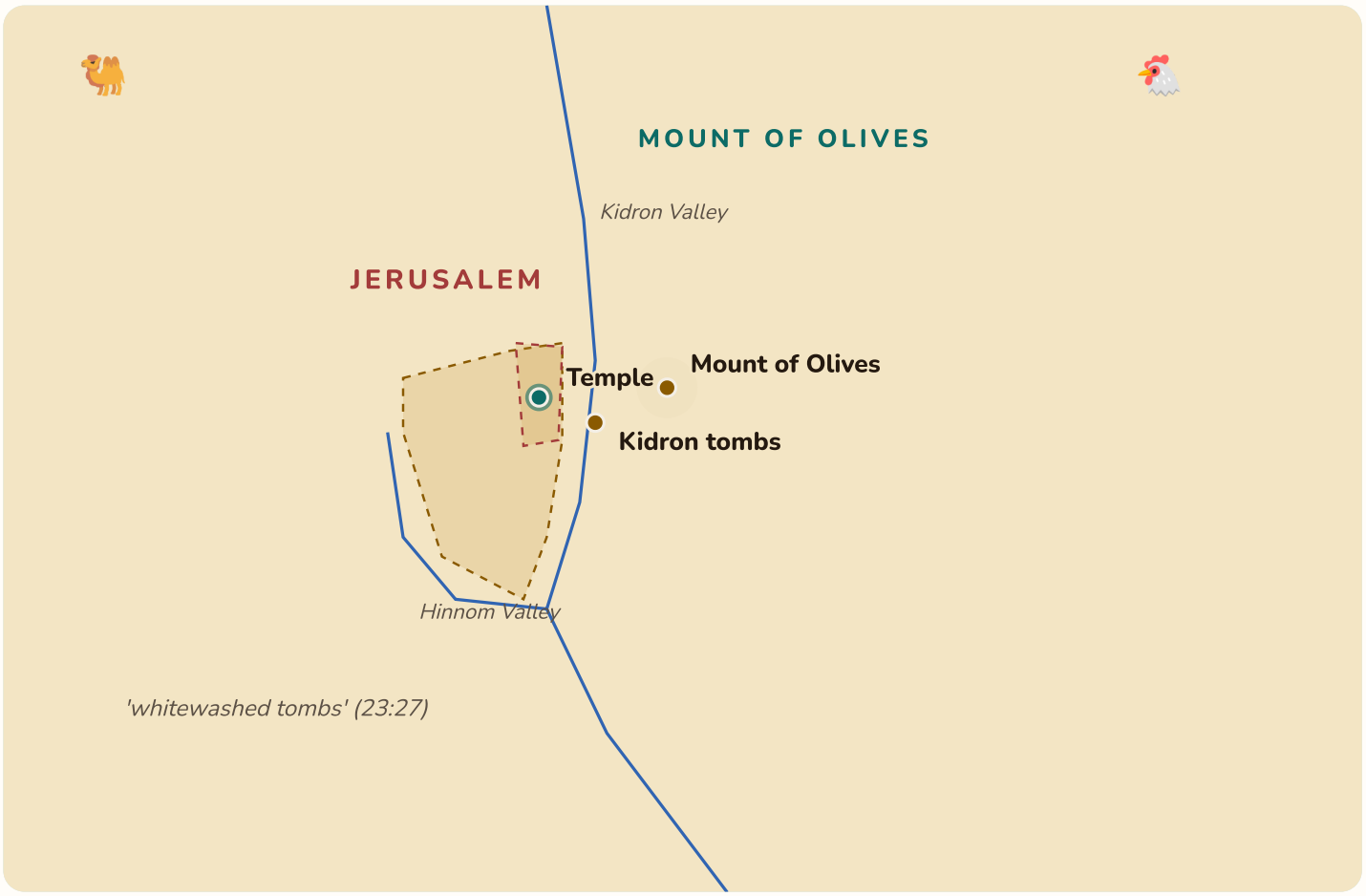
BACKGROUND Melchizedek was king of Salem and priest of God Most High.

Genesis 14:18-20 | ◆ Abraham | ◆ Melchizedek

07 · BACKGROUND

The temple and the tombs

Jesus speaks in the temple (pin outlined in the video's color). Gold pins are background.



● Named in the video ● Background

Schematic: drawn for this study from known sites. Walls (gold dashes) and the temple platform (coral dashes) are approximate for the first century. The surviving Kidron tombs date from about the 2nd and 1st centuries BC.

Temple VIDEO

Jesus speaks in the temple courts; 'your house is being left to you desolate' (23:38).

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

Kidron tombs BACKGROUND

Monumental tombs in the Kidron Valley, later named for prophets and kings: the kind of 'monuments of the righteous' in 23:29.

Mount of Olives BACKGROUND

Pilgrims came over it to the city; Jesus sits there next (24:3).

◆ Factbook: Mount of Olives

08

Key terms

Chair of Moses

VIDEO

The seat of teaching authority; the video compares it to a pulpit.

Phylacteries

VIDEO

Small boxes holding Scripture, worn on the arm and head (Exodus 13:9, 16; Deuteronomy 6:8; 11:18).

◆ Factbook: Moses ◆ Factbook: Moses' seat

◆ Factbook: Phylactery

Tassels

VIDEO

Fringes on the corners of garments with a cord of blue (Numbers 15:38).

◆ Factbook: Tassel (tzitzit) ◆ Factbook: Tassel

Proselyte

VIDEO

A Gentile convert to Judaism; the video says God-fearing Gentiles.

◆ Factbook: Gentiles ◆ Factbook: Proselyte

Woe

VIDEO

A cry of grief and judgment, as in Isaiah 5.

◆ Factbook: Isaiah ◆ Factbook: Woe

Tithe

VIDEO

A tenth given to God (Genesis 14:20; Leviticus 27; Numbers 18; Deuteronomy 12; 14).

◆ Factbook: Tithe

Metonymy

VIDEO

Using a name for something closely related: 'Jerusalem' for its leaders.

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem ◆ Factbook: Metonymy

Chiasm

VIDEO

A mirrored pattern (A B C D C' B' A') whose center carries the main point.

◆ Factbook: Chiasm

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

φυλακτήριον

phylaktērion G5440

Phylactery; literally a safeguard.

Greek · Matt 23:5

◆ Factbook: Phylactery

κράσπεδον

kraspedon G2899

Edge, tassel of a garment.

Greek · Matt 23:5

◆ Factbook: Tassel

οὐαί

ouai G3759

Woe! An interjection of grief or warning.

Greek · Matt 23:13

ὑποκριτής

hypokritēs G5273

Actor, pretender, hypocrite. Look up: BDAG, ὑποκριτής.

◆ Factbook: Woe

Greek · Matt 23:13

◆ Factbook: Hypocrite

προσήλυτος

prosēlytos G4339

Convert, proselyte.

Greek · Matt 23:15

◆ Factbook: Proselyte

κώνωψ

kōnōps G2971

Gnat, mosquito.

Greek · Matt 23:24

◆ Factbook: Gnat

κάμηλος

kamēlos G2574

Camel.

Greek · Matt 23:24

◆ Factbook: Camel

κονιάω

koniaō G2867

To whitewash, plaster with lime.

Greek · Matt 23:27

γέεννα

geenna G1067

Gehenna, hell; named for the Valley of Hinnom.

Greek · Matt 23:15, 33

◆ Factbook: Gehenna ◆ Factbook: Valley of Hinnom

מִשְׁפָּט

mishpat H4941

Justice, judgment.

Hebrew · Mic 6:8

חֶסֶד

hesed H2617

Lovingkindness, steadfast love. Look up: HALOT, חֶסֶד.

Hebrew · Mic 6:8

◆ Factbook: Mercy

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Marking graves

Contact with a grave made a person unclean for seven days (Numbers 19:16). The Mishnah says that on the fifteenth of Adar, about a month before Passover, graves were marked anew, and that graves

Seats of Moses

Carved stone chairs found in ancient synagogues, such as the basalt seat from Chorazin, are often identified as the 'chair of Moses' where a teacher sat.

were marked with lime poured on them (Mishnah Shekalim 1:1; Maaser Sheni 5:1).

Phylacteries

Small leather cases holding the four passages Exodus 13:1-10, 13:11-16, Deuteronomy 6:4-9 and 11:13-21. Examples have been found among the Dead Sea Scrolls.

SOURCED

Early witnesses

> *These things He says, accusing them in respect of vainglory, which kind of thing was their ruin.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 72, on 23:5. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *He called these a gnat, for they are small and nothing, but those other a camel, for they were beyond what men could bear.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 73, on 23:24. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *Behold your house is left desolate... stripped of the succor which comes from me.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 74, on 23:38. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

'Do and keep all that they tell you'?

Some read 23:3 as real respect for the scribes' teaching from Moses; others as irony, since Jesus elsewhere warns against the teaching of the Pharisees (16:12).

Which Zechariah?

Many identify him with Zechariah son of Jehoiada (2 Chronicles 24:20-22); others with the prophet Zechariah son of Berechiah (Zechariah 1:1), or think the two were joined in tradition.

A chiasm?

The video follows an outline of the woes as a chiasm centered on 23:23-24. Others read them as a rising series that climaxes in the last woe and the lament.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The gnat and the camel are in Matthew 23:24 (the video says 23:4).
- The rejected stone is Psalm 118:22 (the video says 18:22).
- The phylacteries held four passages (Exodus 13:1-10, 13:11-16, Deuteronomy 6:4-9 and 11:13-21), not four verses.
- Matthew says Zechariah was 'the son of Berechiah,' but the Zechariah stoned in 2 Chronicles 24 is the son of Jehoiada; the prophet Zechariah is the son of Berechiah (Zechariah 1:1).
- The video's outline of the chiasm labels six of the seven parts; the sixth woe (23:27-28) is not labeled.
- The video's translation leaves out 23:14; the LSB prints it in brackets.

11 · BACKGROUND

From Abram's tithe to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 23 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

c. 2000 BC DEBATED
Abram gives a tenth to Melchizedek
Genesis 14:20

c. 1446 BC DEBATED
Tassels with a cord of blue
Numbers 15:38

c. 800 BC DEBATED
Zechariah stoned in the temple court
2 Chronicles 24:21 *Recalled: 23:35*

c. 740 BC DEBATED
Isaiah's six woes
Isaiah 5:8-23 *Echoed: 23:13-32*

c. 600 BC DEBATED
'I have sent you all My slaves the prophets'
Jeremiah 7:25

c. AD 30 DEBATED
Seven woes and the lament
Matthew 23 *This episode*

c. AD 390
Chrysostom: a gnat and a camel
Matthew 23:24

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Luke 11:37-52
Woes at a Pharisee's table
ADDED

Luke 13:34-35
Jerusalem, Jerusalem
ADDED

Mark 12:38-40
Beware of the scribes
ADDED

Matthew 6:1-18
Righteousness in secret
ADDED

James 3:1
Teachers will incur stricter judgment
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ Why does Jesus save His harshest words for religious leaders?

2 ☐ What is the difference between respecting a teacher's words and copying his life?

3 ☐ What are the 'gnats' and the 'camels' in your own church life?

4 ☐ How do justice, mercy and faithfulness show up in an ordinary week?

5 ☐ Why does performance push out humility?

6 ☐ Why do you obey God: for Him, or to be seen by others?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson: when people commit themselves to hypocritical righteousness, God's word becomes distorted and His will

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

this week do one act of kindness no one will know about, and pray Micah 6:8 each morning.

becomes corrupted, and they become blind to spiritual truth. The teachers of God's word missed God in human flesh standing in front of them because obedience became a performance. Ask why you obey God: is it for Him, or for everyone else to see? Obey in secret, and humility will let you do God's will rightly and see His activity around you.

> *When people commit themselves to hypocritical righteousness, as Jesus defines it, God's word becomes distorted and his will becomes corrupted.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Moses ◆ Camel ◆ Isaiah ◆ Dead Sea Scrolls ◆ Pharisees ◆ Judgment
◆ Righteousness ◆ Kingdom of heaven ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Book of Deuteronomy
◆ Book of Psalms ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Chiasm ◆ Chorazin ◆ Disciples ◆ Gehenna ◆ Gentiles
◆ Hypocrite ◆ Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Mercy ◆ Mishnah ◆ Nicodemus ◆ Oath
◆ Persecution ◆ Prayer ◆ Scribe ◆ Sermon on the Mount ◆ Synagogue ◆ Valley of Hinnom
◆ Zechariah (son of Jehoiada) ◆ Lawlessness ◆ Priest ◆ Tanakh ◆ Messiah ◆ Micah (the prophet)
◆ Parable ◆ Rabbi ◆ Tassel (tzitzit) ◆ Yoke (teaching as a yoke) ◆ Unclean (ritual purity) ◆ Passover
◆ Church ◆ Humility ◆ Cornerstone ◆ Melchizedek ◆ Mount of Olives ◆ Abel ◆ Gnat
◆ Metonymy ◆ Mint ◆ Moses' seat ◆ Phylactery ◆ Proselyte ◆ Tassel ◆ Tithe ◆ Woe

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